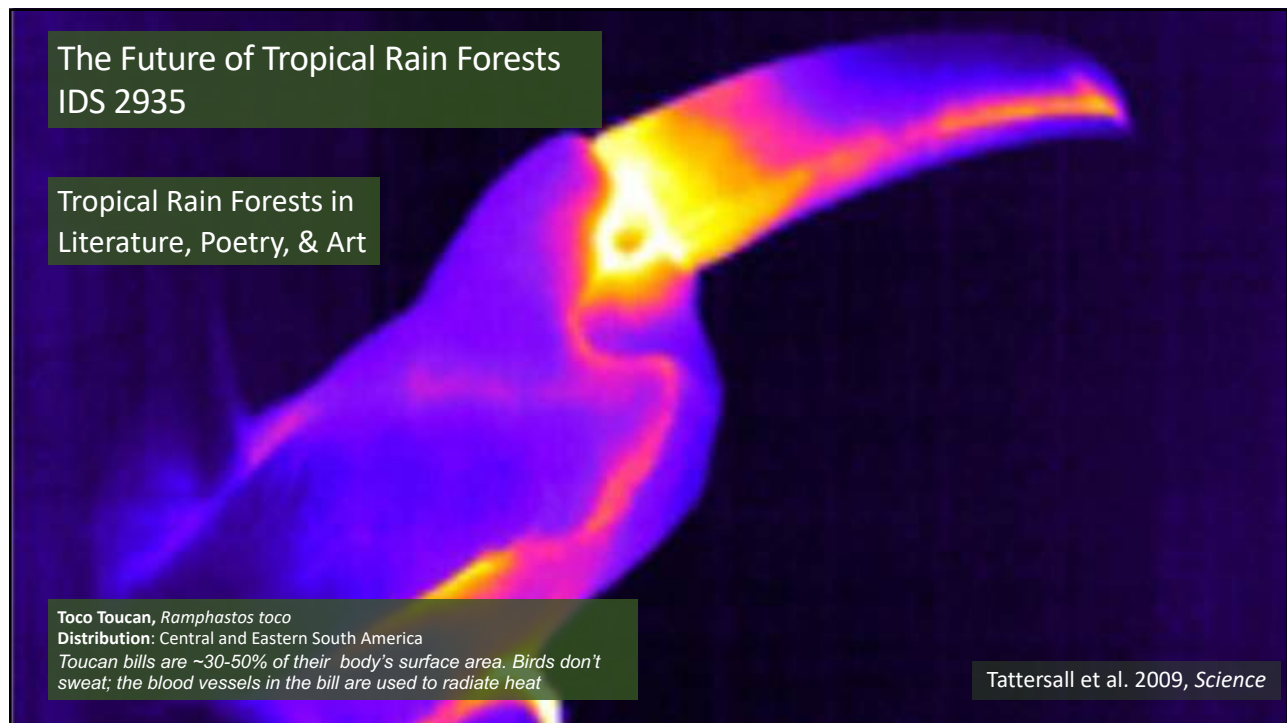




1



2

## major themes (the tropics are...)

Bountiful<sup>(3)</sup>  
Plentiful<sup>(4)</sup>  
Abundant<sup>(6)</sup>  
Lush<sup>(2)</sup> Wild

### 1. PARADISE

Bountiful  
Rich Busy\*  
Underdeveloped

### 2. EXPLOITABLE

\*industrious?

Unforgiving  
Cannibalism  
Hazardous  
Savage<sup>(4)</sup>  
Scary  
Barbaric<sup>(2)</sup>  
Uncivilized<sup>(3)</sup>  
Dangerous<sup>(9)</sup>

### 3. HELL

Mysterious  
Intense  
Lively  
Complicated  
unpredictable

treacherous

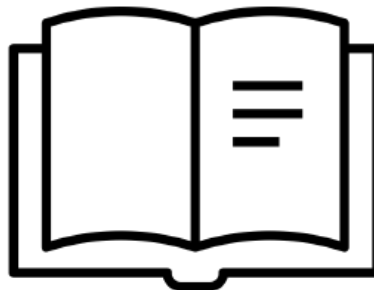
chaotic

### 4. MYSTICAL

Exploitable + Hell + Mystical = **5. CONQUERABLE**

3

## Rain Forests In High & Popular Culture:



Literature & Poetry

4

### TEXT 1: *Utopia*, Thomas Moore (1516)

Under the equator, and as far on both sides of it as the sun moves, there lay vast deserts that were parched with the perpetual heat of the sun; the soil was withered, all things looked dismally, and all places were either quite uninhabited, or abounded with wild beasts and serpents, and some few men, that were neither less wild nor less cruel than the beasts themselves. But, as they went farther, a new scene opened, all things grew milder, the air less burning, the soil more verdant, and even the beasts were less wild: and, at last, there were nations, towns, and cities, that had not only mutual commerce among themselves and with their neighbours, but traded, both by sea and land, to very remote countries.



*The island of Utopia is located near Cabo Frio, Brazil*

5

### TEXT 2: *Paradise Lost*, John Milton (1667)

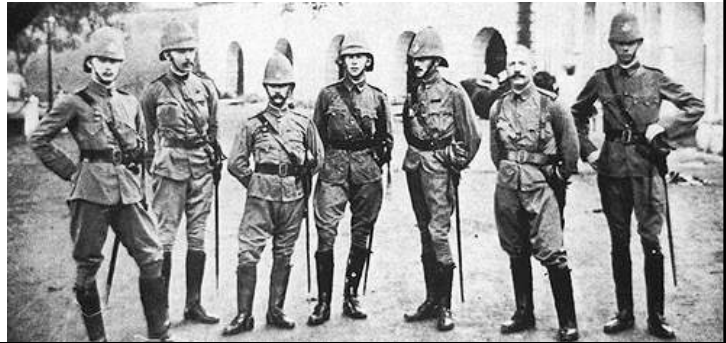
So on he fares, and to the border comes  
Of Eden, where delicious Paradise,  
Now nearer, crowns with her enclosure green,  
As with a rural mound, the champaign head  
Of a steep wilderness, whose hairy sides  
With thicket overgrown, grotesque and wild,  
Access denied; and overhead upgrew  
Insuperable height of loftiest shade,  
Cedar, and pine, and fir, and branching palm,  
A sylvan scene, and, as the ranks ascend,  
Shade above shade, a woody theatre  
Of stateliest view. Yet higher than their tops  
The verdurous wall of Paradise upsprung;  
Which to our general sire gave prospect large  
Into his nether empire neighbouring round.  
And higher than that wall a circling row  
Of goodliest trees, loaden with fairest fruit,  
Blossoms and fruits at once of golden hue,  
Appeared

6



### TEXT 3: *Jungle Book*, Rudyard Kipling (1894)

"Listen, man-cub," said the bear, and his voice rumbled like thunder on a hot night. "I have taught thee all the Law of the Jungle for all the Peoples of the Jungle—except the Monkey Folk who live in the trees. They have no Law. They are outcasts. They have no speech of their own, but use the stolen words which they overhear when they listen and peep and wait up above in the branches. Their way is not our way. They are without leaders. They have no remembrance. They boast and chatter and pretend that they are a great people about to do great affairs in the jungle, but the falling of a nut turns their minds to laughter, and all is forgotten. We of the jungle have no dealings with them. We do not drink where the monkeys drink; we do not go where the monkeys go; we do not hunt where they hunt; we do not die where they die."



7

### Text 4: *The White Man's Burden*, Rudyard Kipling (1899)

Take up the White Man's burden  
Send forth the best ye breed  
Go bind your sons to exile  
To serve your captives' need;  
To wait in heavy harness,  
On fluttered folk and wild  
Your new-caught, sullen peoples,  
Half-devil and half-child



8

## TEXT 5: *Heart of Darkness*, Joseph Conrad (1899)

It was just two months from the day we left the creek when we came to the bank below Kurtz's station. Going up that river was like traveling back to the earliest beginnings of the world, when vegetation rioted on the earth and the big trees were kings. An empty stream, a great silence, an impenetrable forest. The air was warm, thick, heavy, sluggish. There was no joy in the brilliance of sunshine. The long stretches of the waterway ran on, deserted, into the gloom of overshadowed distances... The broadening waters flowed through a mob of wooded islands; you lost your way on that river as you would in a desert, and butted all day long against shoals, trying to find the channel, till you thought yourself bewitched and cut off for ever from everything you had known once somewhere far away — in another existence perhaps. There were moments when one's past came back to one, as it will sometimes when you have not a moment to spare for yourself; but it came in the shape of an unrestful and noisy dream, remembered with wonder amongst the overwhelming realities of this strange world of plants, and water, and silence. And this stillness of life did not in the least resemble a peace. It was the stillness of an implacable force brooding over an inscrutable intention. It looked at you with a vengeful aspect...



...I tried to break the spell—the heavy, mute spell of the wilderness that seemed to draw him to its pitiless breast by the awakening of forgotten and brutal instincts, by the memory of gratified and monstrous passions.

9

## TEXT 6: *Cabbages and Kings*, O. Henry (1905)

Well, then, in three days we sailed alongside that Guatemala... We landed at a town on the coast, where a train of cars was waitin' for us on a dinky little railroad.... We run some forty miles in seven hours, and the train stopped. There was no more railroad. 'Twas a sort of camp in a damp gorge full of wildness and melancholies. They was gradin' and choppin' out the forests ahead to continue the road. 'Here,' says I to myself, 'is the romantic haunt of the revolutionists. Here will Clancy, by the virtue that is in a superior race and the inculcation of Fenian tactics, strike a tremendous blow for liberty. The trees was all sky-scrapers; the underbrush was full of needles and pins; there was monkeys jumpin' around and crocodiles and pink-tailed mockin'-birds, and ye stood knee-deep in the rotten water and grabbed roots for the liberation of Guatemala. Of nights we would build smudges in camp to discourage the mosquitoes, and sit in the smoke, with the guards pacin' all around us.

One old man named Halloran — a man of Hibernian entitlements and discretions, explained it to me. He had been workin' on the road a year. Most of them died in less than six months. He was dried up to gristle and bone, and shook with chills every third night. "Ye're surrounded by a ragin' forest full of disreputable beasts—lions and baboons and anacondas—waitin' to devour ye. The sun strikes ye hard, and

melts the marrow in your bones... The fault's wid these tropics. They rejuices a man's system. 'Tis a land, as the poet says, 'Where it always seems to be after dinner.'"



10



### TEXT 7: *Beyond the Chagres River*, James S Gilbert (1905)

Beyond the Chagres River,  
'Tis said (the story's old),  
Are paths that lead to mountains  
Of purest virgin gold;  
But 'tis my firm conviction  
Whate'er the tales they tell  
Beyond the Chagres River  
All paths lead straight to Hell.



11

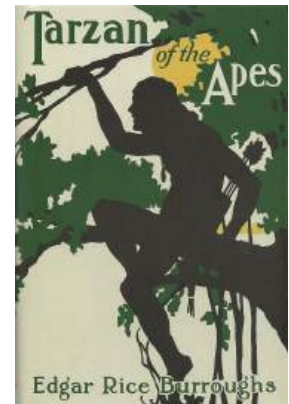
### TEXT 8: *Tarzan of the Apes*, Edgar Rice Burroughs (1912)

Their work done the sailors returned to the small boat, and pulled off rapidly toward the Arrow. Tarzan, an interested spectator of all that had taken place, sat speculating on the strange actions of these peculiar creatures. Men were indeed more foolish and more cruel than the beasts of the jungle! How fortunate was he who lived in the peace and security of the great forest!

p. 192            They were evidently no different from the black men—no more civilized than the apes—no less cruel than Sabor.

p. 197            THIS IS THE HOUSE OF TARZAN, THE KILLER OF BEASTS AND MANY BLACK MEN. DO NOT HARM THE THINGS WHICH ARE TARZAN'S. TARZAN WATCHES.  
                         TARZAN OF THE APES.

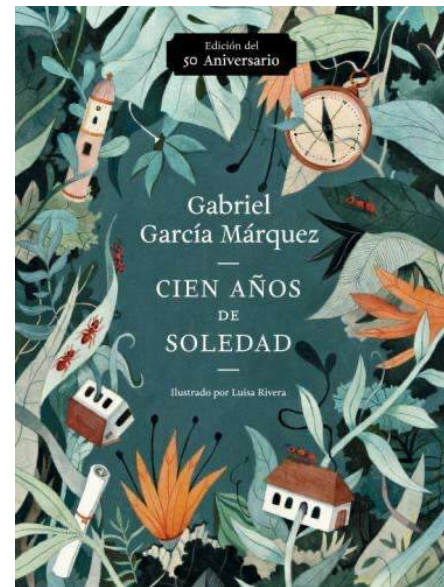
p. 334            He was a soldier of France, and he would teach these beasts how an officer and a gentleman died.



12

**TEXT 9: *One Hundred Years of Solitude*, Gabriel García Márquez (1967)**

Then, for more than ten days, they did not see the sun again. The ground became soft and damp, like volcanic ash, and the vegetation was thicker and thicker, and the cries of the birds and the uproar of the monkeys became more and more remote, and the world became eternally sad. The men on the expedition felt overwhelmed by their most ancient memories in that paradise of dampness and silence, going back to before original sin, as their boots sank into pools of steaming oil and their machetes destroyed bloody lilies and golden salamanders.



13

**TEXT 10: *Eat, Pray, Love: One Woman's Search for Everything Across Italy, India and Indonesia*, Elizabeth Gilbert (2006)**

So I take a taxi to the town of Ubud, which seems like a good place to start my journey. I check into a small and pretty hotel there on the fabulously named Monkey Forest Road. The hotel has a sweet swimming pool and a garden crammed with tropical flowers with blossoms bigger than volleyballs (tended to by a highly organized team of hummingbirds and butterflies). The staff is Balinese, which means they automatically start adoring you and complimenting you on your beauty as soon as you walk in. The room has a view of the tropical treetops and there's a breakfast included every morning with piles of fresh tropical fruit. In short, it's one of the nicest places I've ever stayed and it's costing me less than ten dollars a day. It's good to be back.

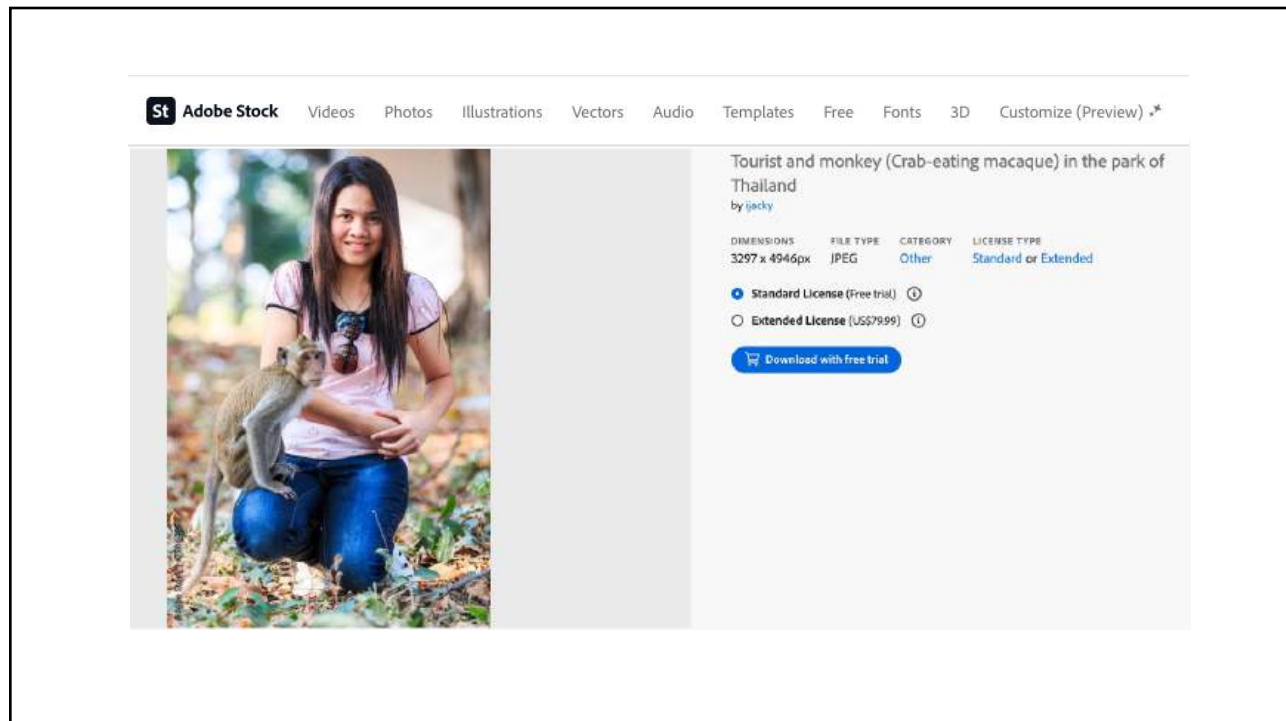
The sound universe is also spectacular around here. In the evenings there's a cricket orchestra with frogs providing the bass line. In the dead of night the dogs howl about how misunderstood they are. Before dawn the roosters for miles around announce how freaking cool it is to be roosters. ("We are ROOSTERS!" they holler. "We are the only ones who get to be ROOSTERS!") Every morning around sunrise there is a tropical birdsong competition, and it's always a ten-way tie for the championship. When the sun comes out the place quiets down and the butterflies get to work. The whole house is covered with vines; I feel like any day it will disappear into the foliage completely and I will disappear with it and become a jungle flower myself. The rent is less than what I used to pay in New York City for taxi fare every month.

I rode my bicycle back home, pushing my happy body up the hills toward my house in the late afternoon sun. On my way through the forest, a big male monkey dropped out of a tree right in front of me and bared his fangs at me. I didn't even flinch. I said, "Back off, Jack—I got four brothers protecting my ass," and I just rode right on by him<sup>1</sup>.



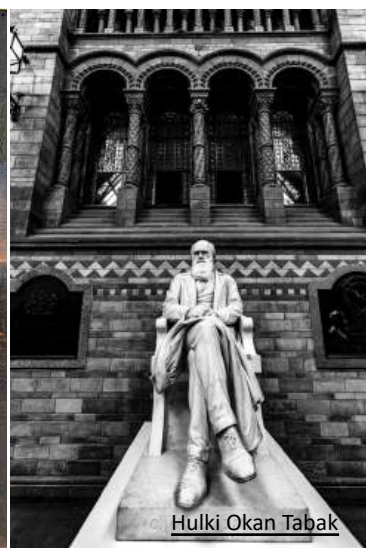
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15

## The Tropics as for destinations for (self)discovery & proving oneself



16





17



18



19



20





21



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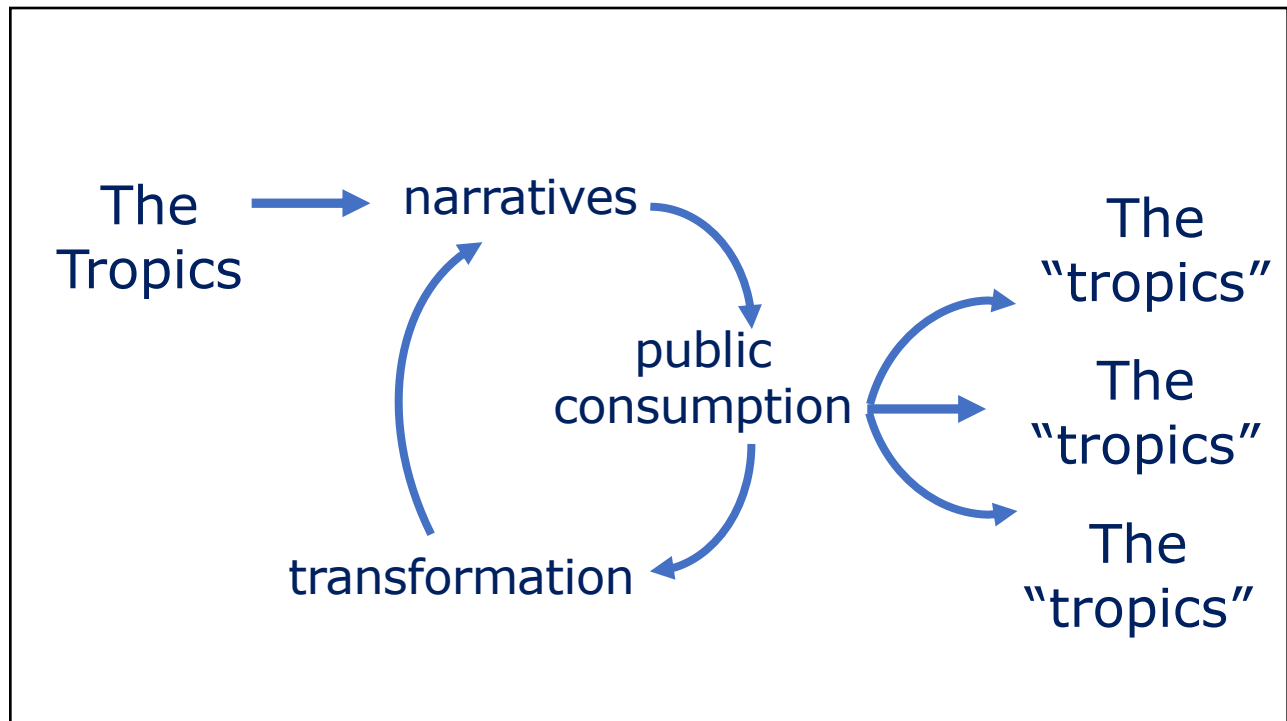




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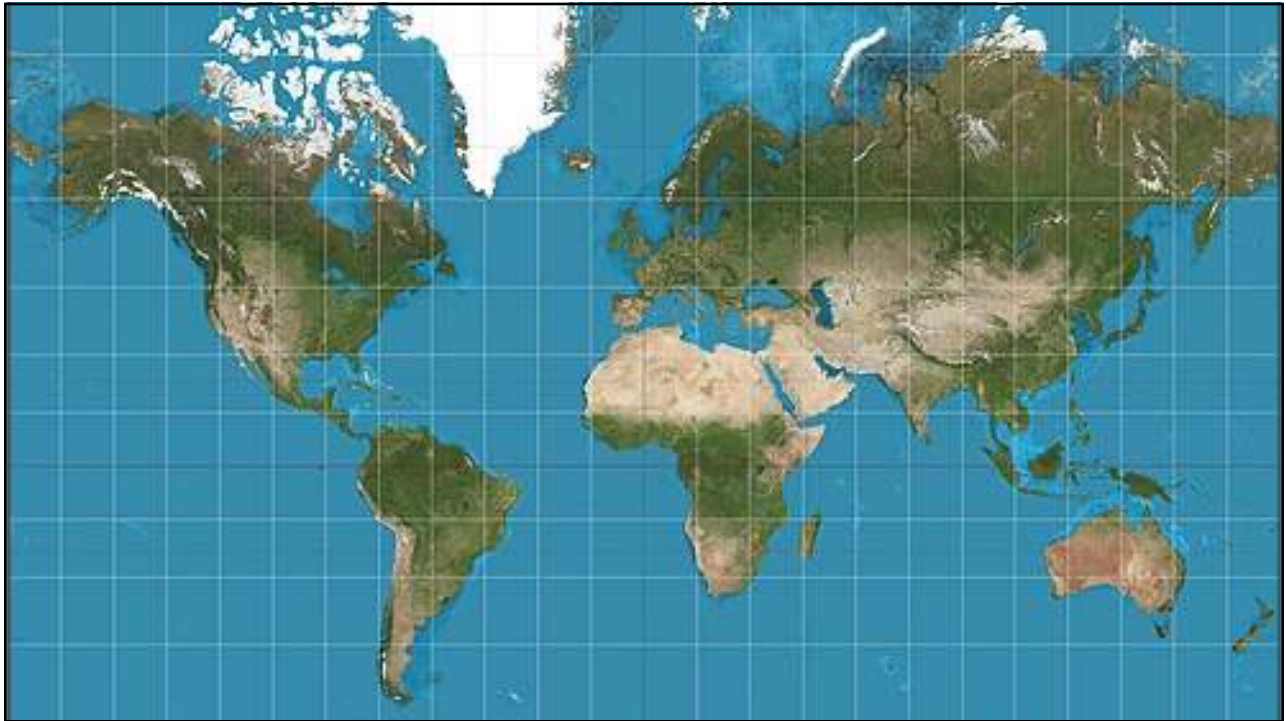
25

“Calling a part of the globe ‘the tropics’ became a Western way of defining something environmentally and culturally distinct from Europe, while also perceiving a high degree of common identity between the constituent regions of the tropical world”.

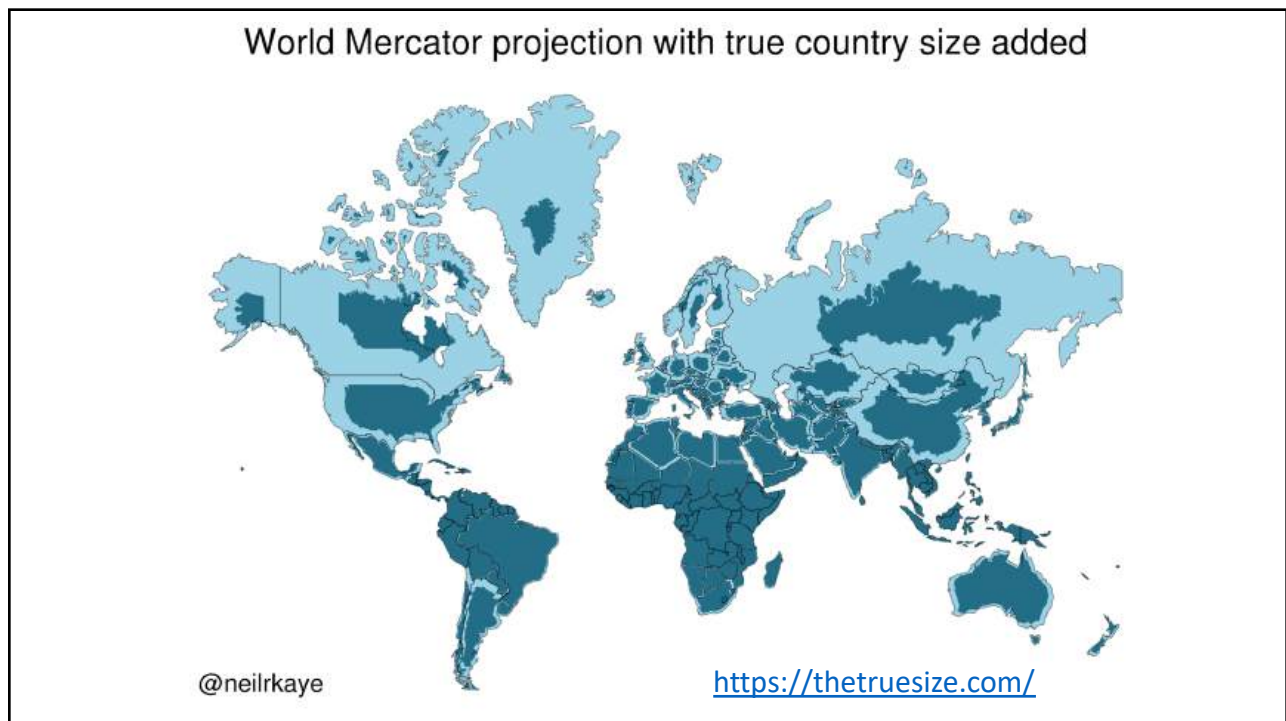
David Arnold (1996) *The Problem of Nature: Environment, Culture and European Expansion*, Oxford: Blackwell.

26





27



28